Alexander Dovnar

DevOps & Cloud Architect

alex@alex-dovnar.in · linkedin.com/in/dovnaralex · alex-dovnar.in · Minsk, Belarus

SUMMARY

DevOps & Cloud Architect with 15 years in infrastructure, 10 of them building scalable, secure platforms on Amazon Web Services (AWS), Oracle Cloud Infrastructure (OCI), Azure and GCP. Deep expertise in Infrastructure as Code (Terraform, OpenTofu, Terragrunt, Helm), Kubernetes, CI/CD and observability. Equally effective as a hands-on engineer and a technical lead: designing cloud architectures, launching 10+ production systems end-to-end, optimizing cost and mentoring engineers. Co-author of "Cracking the Kubernetes Interview" (Packt, 2025). Actively applies AI to engineering: coding agents, MCP integrations and agentic workflows.

SKILLS

Cloud: AWS (expert), Azure, GCP, Oracle Cloud, Yandex Cloud, VK Cloud

IaC & Automation: Terraform / OpenTofu, Terragrunt, Helm, Helmfile, Ansible, Packer, Vault

Containers & Orchestration: Docker, Kubernetes, ArgoCD

CI/CD: GitHub Actions, GitLab CI, Jenkins, Travis CI

Observability: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, VictoriaMetrics, OpenSearch, OpenTelemetry

Security & FinOps: IAM hardening, secrets management, SBOM / supply-chain controls, cost optimization

AI Engineering: AI-assisted development with coding agents (Claude Code, Cursor, GitHub Copilot); building & integrating MCP servers; agentic workflow design & LLM-driven automation

Scripting: Python, Bash

EXPERIENCE

Tech Lead / Senior DevOps Engineer — Naviteq Ltd

Jan 2022 – Present

- Delivered 10+ client projects end-to-end, from architecture design to production.
- Built Runestra, the company's DevOps accelerator, as sole developer, then grew it into a two-engineer product: 62 Terraform/OpenTofu modules for AWS and OCI, 42 hardened Helm charts and 34 reusable GitHub Actions workflows. A new client environment goes from an empty account to production in under an hour instead of 4–8 weeks.
- Designed the observability migration from Prometheus to VictoriaMetrics for a global cybersecurity vendor's SASE platform: ~20,000 gateways across ~60 production regions.
- Built a cloud-agnostic Kubernetes platform from scratch for a security startup later acquired by GitLab.
- Moved EKS clusters from Cluster Autoscaler to Karpenter, raising node utilization from ~70% to 90%+.
- Architected and deployed highly available, secure AWS infrastructure with cost optimization (saved up to 40%).
- Standardized reusable Terraform/Terragrunt templates and CI/CD pipelines across teams.
- Operated Kubernetes clusters and authored Helm charts to streamline deployments.
- Built monitoring and logging stacks with Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, and OpenSearch.
- Mentored engineers through code reviews and architecture guidance.

Senior DevOps Engineer — OneSoil

Aug 2021 – May 2022 (consulting)

- Designed a multi-account AWS architecture aligned to security and scalability best practices.
- Reduced cloud costs by ~30% with no loss of performance.

- Built a Kubernetes platform for scalable deployments.
- Added observability with Prometheus and Grafana.

Lead System Engineer — EPAM Systems
Apr 2016 – Aug 2021

- Grew from junior to lead engineer over five years.
- Designed AWS infrastructure and automated it with Terraform and Ansible.
- Built and maintained CI/CD pipelines with GitLab CI and Jenkins.
- Led the team as tech lead: planned work, assigned tasks, and reviewed solutions.
- Migrated enterprise systems to the cloud (AWS, Azure).
- Delivered several international projects across fintech and retail.

Senior Network Engineer — RUE Beltelecom
Mar 2011 – Apr 2016

- Supported clients consuming Internet, VoIP, and IPTV services.
- Maintained the backbone network and corporate clients (VPN, Ethernet, SHDSL).
- Automated network equipment maintenance with custom scripts.

CERTIFICATIONS

- AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Professional (2023–2026)
- AWS Certified Security – Specialty (2022–2025)
- Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA, 2025–2027)
- Certified Kubernetes Security Specialist (CKS, 2025–2027)
- Kubestronaut (2025)
- HashiCorp Certified: Terraform Associate
- Cisco CCNA

COMMUNITY & PUBLIC ACTIVITY

- Co-author, "Cracking the Kubernetes Interview" (Packt, 2025, 560 pages; with Viktor Vedmich and Viktoria Semaan)
- Speaker: DevOpsDays Kazakhstan 2024 (talk and workshop), AWS Community Day Almaty 2025 (EKS cost-optimization workshop), DKT Conf 2026 (co-organizer and speaker)
- DevOps Kitchen Talks — co-host (2020–present); 100+ episodes, 300k+ views
- AWS Community Builder (2023–present)
- Terragrunt Ambassador (2025–present)
- Slurm.io — author & trainer for DevOps/SRE courses (CI/CD, Kubernetes, Terraform)

EDUCATION

- Engineer, Belarusian State University of Informatics and Radioelectronics (BSUIR), 2015 — Information Technologies and Management in Technical Systems